Law Manager Data Quality Tracker

Introduction

The Data Quality team's progress in reducing systemic data errors in Law Manager has been successful. In order to organize and track this progress, a SQL query has been developed to track errors and updates made specifically by the team's members. This is to ensure the workflow stays constant and priority items that affect attorney cases or attorney case management dashboards are maintained.

The report aims to track corrections to the matter table, case appearances, and charge tables. These edits should correspond to error corrections for: case updates, court dates, appearance updates, and initial top charges. The process is semi-automatic, where a user needs to run two scripts and extract the data into the proper folder.

As of March 2026, the Data Quality team makes 1500 error corrections a month, mainly to court dates and top charges, on 29,000 active cases (with somewhere between 30,000 and 40,000 new case appearances a month as a loose observation from the UCE feed. This suggests a systematic error rate of 4%-5%).

Methodology

A SQL script is used to extract the data using the individual user ID in the *updated_by* or *added_by* fields in Law Manager. This represents a snapshot of all user updates to Matter, Case Appearance, and Initial Top Charge, tables. Note that new updates by users outside of the team will overwrite the values in these fields, resulting in an actual undercount of error corrections made by the team. It is recommended that regular snapshots be taken once every two weeks to once a month, to balance reporting needs and staff time.

After the data is extracted, a Python script concatenates an archive of all the snapshot data from SQL, creating historical (or panel) data. In Python, the data is further processed using standardized dates and are formatted into a pivot table automatically. This is the most accurate way to account for the Data Quality team's progress.

Analysis

The **case appearance error corrections** correspond to missing court dates, case disposition closures, conflict assignments, and first appearance validations. These updates are generally associated with the quality of digital case files. Since June 2025 through March 2026, an estimated total of 5900 corrections to case appearances. Over the last six months, an average of 739 cases have been corrected by the Data Coordinator team.

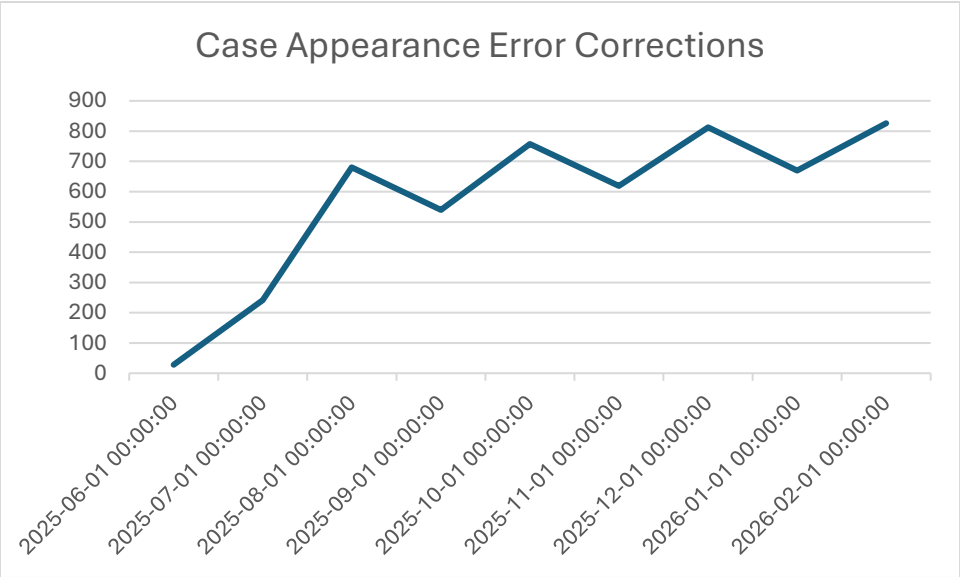

Figure 1

The **matter error corrections** correspond to updates to the current top charge, and notations for case consolidations. The current top charge corrections feed directly into Supervising Attorney dashboards, which use charge types in weighing attorney case load. Since July 2025 there were 5875 corrections to case matters, and an average of 919 corrections over the past six months.

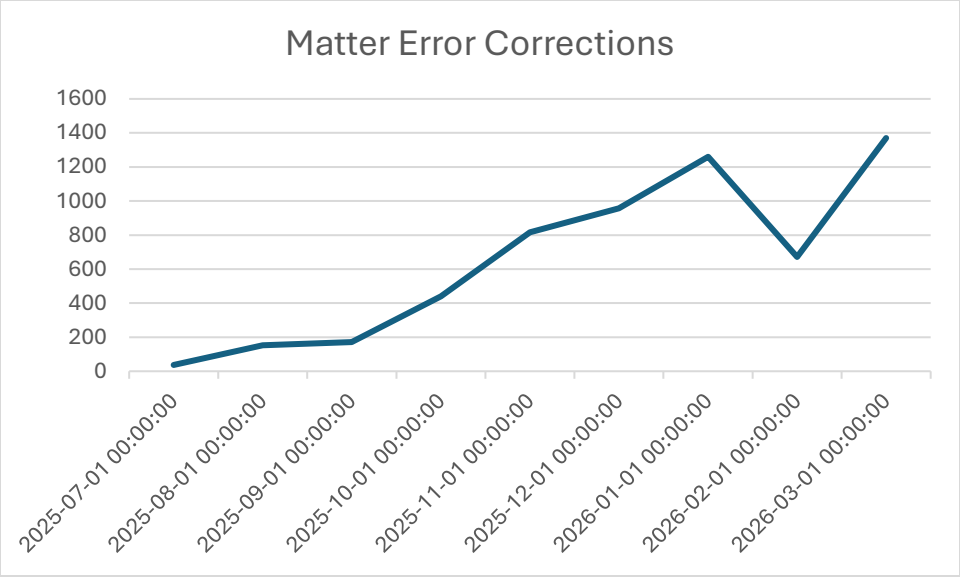

Figure 2

Corrections to the initial top charges, via the charge table, tracks additions made to the initial top charges. These correspond to charges found on the criminal complaint, which can sometimes be missing from the case entry. This project is less of a priority than the previous two. So far, since August 2025, there have been 595 corrections.

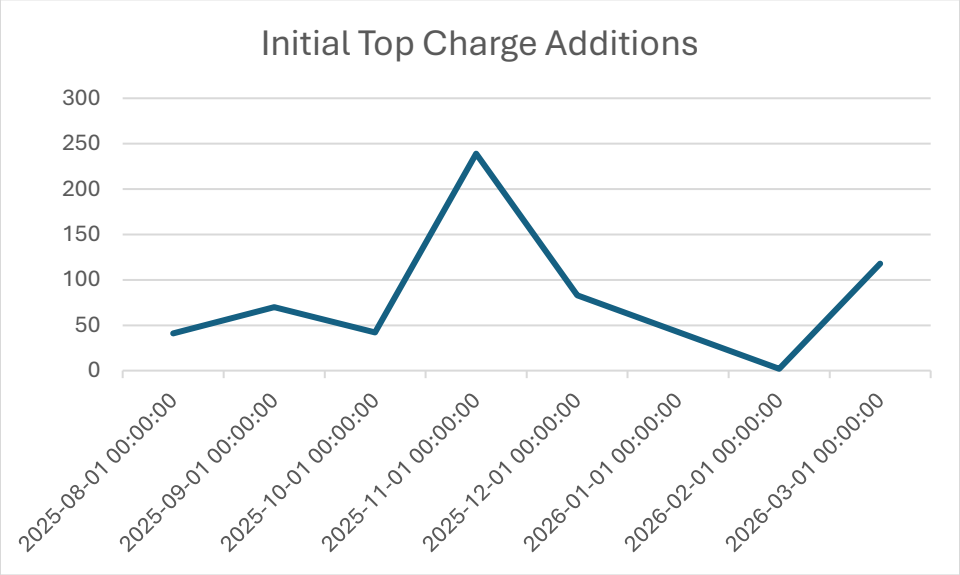

Figure 3

Future Considerations:

As certain project enter the team's workflow, new SQL queries would need to be made to track those snapshots as well. And more of the report is expected to be automated going forward. Power BI integration is also possible. Integration into Power BI is also possible.

With this report, we can track data inflows and outflows and respond to the needs of Legal Aid efficiently. The stock of past errors is expected to wind down, and the team's focus would be directed to incoming errors or to help with other tasks such as Salesforce data migration.

For any questions please contact Erwin at ema@legal-aid.org.